This book is divided into 5 parts, 36 chapters, and 2 appendices. Ideally, you will read the book cover to cover and then use it as a reference, but I realize that this approach won't suit everyone. Although I use small sample apps to demonstrate a topic, some chapters build on the work of previous ones, so the content will make more sense when read sequentially.

I strongly suggest reading the chapters in part 1 in sequence, as each chapter builds on topics introduced in the previous chapters and provides a basis for the rest of the book. Part 2 is also best read sequentially, though most of the chapters are independent if you wish to jump around. Part 3, again, is best read sequentially. You'll get the best experience by reading the chapters in parts 4 and 5 sequentially, but many of the topics are independent, so you can read them out of order if you prefer. But I recommend only doing so after you've covered parts 1 to 3.

Part 1 provides a general introduction to ASP.NET Core, focusing on building small JSON APIs by using the latest features introduced in .NET 7. After we cover the basics, we look at building minimal API applications that provide the simplest programming model for ASP.NET Core web applications.

- Chapter 1 introduces ASP.NET Core and its place in the web development landscape. It describes the type of applications you can build, some of the reasons to choose ASP.NET Core, and the basics of web requests in an ASP.NET Core application.
- Chapter 2 looks at why you should consider using any web framework, why ASP.NET Core was created, and the different application paradigms you can use with ASP.NET Core. Finally, it looks at the situations when you should and shouldn't choose ASP.NET Core.